

Music 246 - Lecture 3

Technical Details, How It's Done:

Basic Timetable of Film Production

Preproduction:

- Preparation: script / financing / casting / costume and set design / location scouting



Production:

- finalization of script and production design
- principle photography

Postproduction:

- editing film / audio and visual effects
- composition and addition of music - release date
- one of the final elements to be created and added to the film.
- 5 to 8 weeks on average.

Composer's involvement varies based on working style and specifics of a given project.

Scripts:

- can give composers a "head start"
- research
- source music
- scripts can change significantly
- only words, no clear timing or pace for the composer to work with.

Screenings:

- several different opportunities to see the film
- rushes
- assembly cut
- rough cut
- fine or locked cut: most if not all editing completed
- most composers begin serious work at the fine cut phase – why?

Spotting Session and Cue Sheets:



- director, composer, music editor/music supervisor
- discussion on placement of “cues”
- timings, approach, etc....
- “Spotting notes” or cue sheet



Music Spotting Notes

Production: "Craven Black" (B4598/1)
Composer: Richard Brice

Cue#	Start	Stop	Duration	Notes
1M1	01:00:35:17	01:01:04:04	30	Main Title
1M2	01:01:19:03	01:01:25:14	06	Shot of Paris, happy (accordion style) until settle on car LS, then ominous, tail under next dialogue
1M3	01:05:23:25	01:05:35:12	12	SOURCE: Main Title in new arrangement as heard on car radio
1M4	01:06:02:00	01:06:04:05	02	Sting the cut to news headline, out on reverse angle on Pierre

Temp Music:

- “temporary” music added to film while still in production or early editing.
- often taken from other film scores, or “classical” music.
- gives more “finished” feeling to work in progress.

Composers are deeply divided on their view of temp music – why?

Composing:

- 5 to 8 weeks until “delivery” of finished score
- short timeline due to fixed release date
- frequently exacerbated by production phase running overtime



Orchestrators – skilled in composition, music theory, and knowledge of the orchestra.

A printed musical score for the piece "Many Meetings" by Dimitri Tiomkin. The score is arranged for a full orchestra, with parts for C Flute, Oboe, BB Clarinet, Bassoon, Horn in F, 1st Trumpet, 2nd Trumpet, Trombone, Tuba, Mallet Percussion (Chimes), Timpani, Percussion (Mallets, Snare, Tom, Bells, Opened Long Tom, Tom Tom, Bass Drum, Suspended Cymbal, Crash Cymbal), Piano/Harp, Violin 1, Violin 2, Viola, Cello, and Double Bass. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 68. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings. At the bottom, there is a copyright notice: "© 1961 NEW LINE TUNES (ASCAP) The Arrangement © 1961 NEW LINE TUNES (ASCAP) All Rights Reserved including Public Performance."

- synth demonstrations



- *copyists* produce final parts for musicians
- *music librarians* organize parts for recording sessions
- *conductors* and *studio musicians* (good sight readers)

- recording sessions



-mixing

Thomas Newman – Wall-E:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sg7dzJgljqY&list=RD0YGbcfXF1Gs>

John Williams – The Phantom Menace <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=46p-v2eFiaQ>

Western Classical Music History (in 15 minutes...)

Baroque Period (1600-1750)

Key Composers: Vivaldi, Handel, Bach.

Development of “Common Practice” – major/minor system of music theory.

Musical structures most important.

Even tempos, consistent textures, terraced dynamics.

Example: J.S. Bach, “Brandenburg Concerto No. 6” 3rd Movement (1721)

Classical Period (1730-1820)

Key Composers: Mozart, Haydn, Beethoven.

Greater focus on melody and emotion.

Expanding variety of tempo, texture and dynamics.

Example: W.A. Mozart, “Symphony No. 40” 1st Movement. (1788)

Romantic Period (1800-1910)

Key Composers: Wagner, Tchaikovsky, Strauss.

Expression of emotion was most important.

Even greater range of tempo, texture and dynamics in service of emotion and narrative.

Example: R. Wagner, “The Magic Fire Music” from *Die Walkure* (1870)



THE SILENT ERA: (1895-1927)

Melodramas:

The Persistence of Vision:



- The Zoopraxiscope (1879)
- project several images to present the illusion of movement

- Thomas Edison:



- The Kinetoscope (1891) Peephole viewer with a continuous loop of film
- The Kinetophone (1895) A kinetoscope with a phonograph installed in the box.
- Problem with synchronization:

First Projected Films:

- The Lumiere Brothers, Paris December 28th, 1895.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6Uo3hV-BWv4>

Reasons for musical accompaniment:

- 1/ Pragmatic: mechanical noise / mechanical problems
- 2/ Psychoanalytic: Audience disturbed by ghost like images
- 3/ Continuity of Tradition: Long history of musical accompaniment for visual presentation.

During the Silent Era:

Three general approaches to music: adaptations/compilations of classical music, adaptations/compilations of popular songs, or originally composed scores or improvised scores.

- In general, films could be shown anywhere, but gradually certain venues come to dominate film showings.

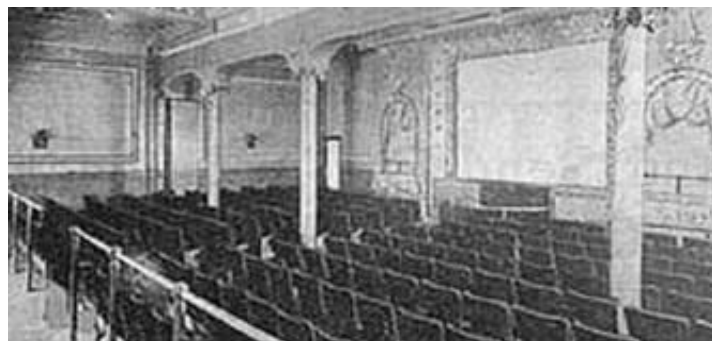
Venues:



Vaudeville Theatres:

- Live variety show
- First began to include films in 1896.
- Musical accompaniment provided by vaudeville orchestra
- By the 1920s the popularity of film led to the decline of Vaudeville.

Nickelodeons: first appear in 1905



- 1907 – 3,000; 1910 – Over 10,000

- Nickelodeon music provided by piano, player piano, small ensemble or gramophone.



The Shift To Narrative:

George Melies:

- early experimenter with camera effects
- *A Trip to the Moon* (1902)



- Not the first narrative, but over ten minutes in length, multiple scenes, sets, costumes etc – early model for narrative film to come.

EXAMPLE: “A Trip To The Moon (1902)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qcyZ70tO9-Q>

1905-1910

- Narrative films become most important style - films become longer, plots become more complex.

- Change in musical aesthetic from entertaining the audience to “**playing the picture.**” Supporting the drama and helping the audience to follow the plot.
“**Fitting**” or “**Synchronizing**”



1910 – 1920s

- film industry matures.
- The rise of Hollywood

- Films become longer, more sophisticated.
- First of the “Movie Palaces” built, 1912.

Larger Orchestras and Theatre Organs.



Changes in musical accompaniment:

Some early attempts at creating original scores, but standard practice is either compilation of classical or popular music, or improvisation.

However, increasing complexity of film narratives and a growing attention to the role of music leads to numerous attempts to standardize the music for a specific film.

Early Cue Sheets:

1909: Edison Film Company - "musical suggestions"

- general scene-by-scene suggestions for musical accompaniment

1912 Max Winkler (Carl Fischer Music) specific pieces of music with timings.

- films shipped with the cue sheets, might also include sheet music

**Musical Suggestions for
THE KING OF KINGS**
By ROY ROBERTSON.

NOTE TO MUSICAL DIRECTORS.—We strongly advise all Musical Directors to obtain the Original Score for this film, as it is most difficult to obtain correct synchronization without it.

Scene	Musical Suggestion	Time of Music	Composer	Editor
1. (Intro.)	March from The King of Kings	0:00-0:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
2. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	0:15-0:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
3. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	0:30-0:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
4. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	0:45-1:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
5. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	1:00-1:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
6. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	1:15-1:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
7. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	1:30-1:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
8. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	1:45-2:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
9. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	2:00-2:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
10. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	2:15-2:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
11. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	2:30-2:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
12. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	2:45-3:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
13. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	3:00-3:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
14. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	3:15-3:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
15. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	3:30-3:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
16. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	3:45-4:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
17. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	4:00-4:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
18. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	4:15-4:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
19. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	4:30-4:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
20. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	4:45-5:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
21. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	5:00-5:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
22. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	5:15-5:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
23. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	5:30-5:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
24. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	5:45-6:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
25. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	6:00-6:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
26. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	6:15-6:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
27. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	6:30-6:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
28. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	6:45-7:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
29. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	7:00-7:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
30. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	7:15-7:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
31. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	7:30-7:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
32. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	7:45-8:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
33. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	8:00-8:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
34. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	8:15-8:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
35. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	8:30-8:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
36. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	8:45-9:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
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39. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	9:30-9:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
40. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	9:45-10:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
41. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	10:00-10:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
42. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	10:15-10:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
43. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	10:30-10:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
44. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	10:45-11:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
45. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	11:00-11:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
46. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	11:15-11:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
47. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	11:30-11:45	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
48. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	11:45-12:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
49. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	12:00-12:15	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
50. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	12:15-12:30	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
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52. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	12:45-1:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler
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100. (The King of Kings)	March from The King of Kings	12:45-1:00	Max Winkler	Max Winkler

One page of the elaborate music-suggestion sheet issued with all major features of the late silent period.

**DOUGLAS FAIRBANKS
"THE THIEF OF BAGDAD"**
A Feature of the Arabian Nights
Music compiled by James C. Rodford
Released by
UNITED ARTISTS CORPORATION

1. PERSONNEL OF DIRECTION, ETC. 26 Min.

2. (Trio) DOUGLAS FAIRBANKS IN THE THIEF OF BAGDAD 14 Min.

3. (Trio) A STREET IN BAGDAD 14 Min.

4. (Action) THIEF GRABS MAN AT WELL 14 Min.

5. (Action) THIEF WALKS AWAY LAUGHING 14 Min.

6. (Action) MAGICIAN WITH BASKET 14 Min.

7. (Action) WOMAN APPEARS ON BALCONY 14 Min.

Resource books:

- books purchased by musicians filled with short pieces of music arranged by mood or action
- *Sam Fox Moving Picture Music* (Vol 1, 1913) J.S.Zamenik

**SAM FOX
MOVING PICTURE
MUSIC**
By J. S. ZAMECNIK
VOL. 1 PRICE 50 CENTS

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Published by Sam Fox Pub. Co., Cleveland, O.

**HURRY MUSIC
(FOR DUELS)**
J. S. ZAMECNIK.

Lively.

Music for Duels: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pupCeh1zqbo>



Trade papers:

Motion Picture World, Moving Picture World

- Included articles and columns on musical accompaniment
- continuous
- source music
- use of themes
- “good music” (classical music) to the masses

But in reality, by the 1920s musical accompaniment would still vary greatly from place to place.

- vast range of performing forces and skills
- missing cue sheets and scores
- issues of “control”

Fun Stuff:

The art of Foley: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UO3N_PRIgX0&t=387s

(For those interested in learning a bit more about the problems with Temp tracks, I recommend this short video: *The Marvel Symphonic Universe*. It shows several examples of scenes including the temp track followed by the final cue written for the scene – the similarities are quite striking and show how temp tracks can limit the range of things a composer might try – the discussion of Temp tracks begins at around the 6:00 mark. (though the first part is also quite interesting).

<https://www.theverge.com/2016/9/12/12893622/hollywood-temp-scores-every-frame-a-painting-film>)